

music festival

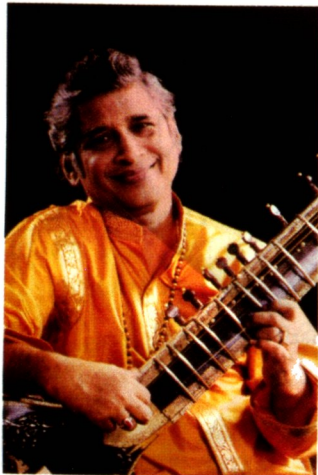
Tuning to Glory

DELHI One festival every musician and music lover looks forward to in the Capital is the annual Vishnu Digambar Jayanti Sangeet Samaroh organised by the Gandharva Mahavidyalaya and the Saraswati Samaj. It is like a pilgrimage for musicians who perform at this festival where they pay their homage to the musicologist and vocalist, Vishnu Digambar Paluskar. Musicians don't charge for their performance. "If today there are good classical music listeners, much of it is due to Paluskarji who believed in imparting music education to the masses rather than classes," says Madhup Mudgal, the principal of the Gandharva Mahavidyalaya in Pune.

The festival will begin with the Kedia brothers from Ranchi—Mor Mukut on the sitar and Manoj Kumar on the sarod. They have studied music under Ustad Ali Akbar Khan and Annapurna Devi, and are under the tutelage of sarod maestro Sunil Mukherjee. The duo will

present the Maihar gharana tradition with finesse. They will be followed by the turbo-voiced Ulhas Kashalkar of the Gwalior gharana. On the second day, Manjusha Patil from Sangli, a small town in western Maharashtra which has produced legends like Lata Mangeshkar, will go on stage, to be followed by santoor maestro Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma. On the third day in the morning, Pandit Anindo Chatterjee and Anubrata Chatterjee will perform a duet accompanied by Murad Ali on the sarangi. One will listen to some morning ragas by sitar maestro Debu Chaudhuri, disciple of Ustad Mushtaq Ali Khan. Chaudhuri is known for his wealth of musical ideas and the range of instrumental vocabulary. His supple fingers will be seen working the sitar. In the evening, the carnatic flute will come alive in the hands of young Shashank Subramanyam. He will be followed by the guru of rasas, Pandit Jasraj. Come soak into some pure classical music. At Kamani Auditorium from August 1 to 3. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

MAGICAL STROKES: Chaudhuri (left); Subramanyam



theatre festival

A Dance in Trance

CHENNAI The Hindu Metroplus Theatre Festival is on its way, with a great compilation of Indian and foreign plays. The Indian collection comprises plays like *Lore Letters* directed by Rahul Da Cunha, *Creeper* by Ram Ganesh Kamatham and *The Suit* directed by Neelam Mansingh. The foreign plays include *The Whale from Concrete Temple Theatre, New York* and an Indo-German production titled *Electronic City*. The most awaited production of the festival is the award-winning Korean adaptation of Shakespeare's *A Midsummer Night's Dream* by the Yohangza Theatre Company directed by Jung Ung Yang. This play, with English subtitles, will incorporate themes from Korean culture and folklore. Being brought to India by the Inko Centre and the Korea Foundation, in association with AsiaNow Production, it presents theatre lovers from India with a great opportunity to witness the renowned plays of Korea. It will last a week starting from August 1.

by Nirmala Ravindran

Korean actors performing *A Midsummer Night's Dream*



art exhibition

Colours in Chaos

MUMBAI Aura, a collection of acrylics on canvas by artist Niki Bhaskar, draws from Rajasthani art, design, music and history. Inspired by the concept of auras, Bhaskar's art reflects what she sees and feels. Her paintings exhibit a vastness of scale, a chaos of colour, interspersed lines which depict a sense of



A work by Bhaskar

being and nature. The exhibition will be held at Museum Art Gallery. From July 28 to August 4.

by Swati Mathur